large seismically generated sea waves caused by Earthquakes, submarine explosions and landslides. These waves travel at a great speed (more than 500 km per hour) and the length of the waves exceeds 600 km. These waves reach to a height of more than 15 m near the sea shore and are capable of causing destruction along the coastal area.

The 2004 Indian Ocean Earthquake that caused tsunami is the sixth-deadliest natural disaster which travelled at a speed of 600 km per hour with an estimated death toll of 2,80,000. The Earthquake which occurred near Indonesia at 00.58 hours took nearly 7 hours to reach Chennai.

DO YOU KNOW?

On 26 December 2004 a tsunami occurred in the Indian Ocean. It was the **result** of the Indio-Australian Plate **subducting** below the Eurasian Plate. It was caused by an Earthquake **measuring** a magnitude of above 9 in the Richter scale. The Earthquake caused the **seafloor** to **uplift**, displacing the seawater above.

Volcanoes

A volcano is a vent or an opening on the surface of the Earth crust, through which hot solid, liquid and gaseous materials (**Magma**) erupt out to the surface from the Earth's interior. Magma rises up and ejects on the surface as **Lava**. Volcanoes are also formed when plates move apart.

Volcanoes generally have the following major components. They are:

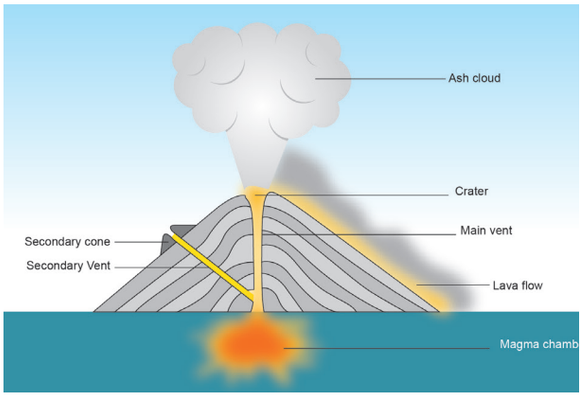
i. Magma chamber - a large pool of liquid rock found beneath the surface of the Earth
ii. Vents - an opening serving as an outlet for air, smoke, fumes, magma etc
iii. Volcanic cone - a landform built by the magma ejected from the vent in the shape of a cone.
iv. Crater - a bowl shaped depression found at the top of the volcano through which the magma flows out.

Based on the periodicity **of eruptions**, volcanoes are classified into

(i) Active volcano, (ii) Dormant volcano, (iii) Extinct volcano.

DO YOU KNOW?

The term 'volcano' is derived from the Latin term VULCAN, which is the name of Roman "God of Fire".



a Active Volcano



Active volcanoes are those which constantly eject volcanic lava, gases and fragmented materials. (eg.) Mount St. Helens in the United States.

b Dormant Volcano (or) Sleeping Volcano



Volcanoes that do not show any sign of volcanic activity for a long period of time are known as dormant volcanoes. Sometimes there may be a sudden explosion which may cause unimaginable loss to life and property (e.g.) Mt. Fujiyama, Japan

c Extinct or Dead Volcano

When a volcano permanently stops its volcanic activity, then it is

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